



Joseph Aplin Martin was a soldier in the American Civil War. He was born on December 12, 1843. Aplin spent the early part of his life in Claysville, Ohio, a town located in Westland Township of Guernsey County. At the age of nineteen, he joined up with the 97th Regiment of Ohio Volunteer Infantry, which was organized on September 2, 1862 at Zanesville, Ohio. Except for a stay at a convalescent's camp in Nashville, Aplin was with the 97th until his death in USA General Hospital at Tullahoma, Tennessee on July 2, 1864 from Gun Shot wound in the leg. The 97th OVI participated in only three battles prior to 1864: Perryville, Kentucky; Stone River, Tennessee; and Mission Ridge, Tennessee. Aplin was initially buried in Murfreesborough; his remains were later sent to New Concord, Ohio in 1866.

The correspondence of and on Joseph Aplin Martin spans from 1847 to 1878 and documents Aplin's participation in the American Civil War and the aftermath of his death while in combat. The majority of the letters are addressed to Aplin's mother, Eleanor Kelley, letting her know that he was "still in the land of the living." The rest of the correspondence includes letters regarding the return of Aplin's remains to Ohio, and letters to Eleanor Kelley after her son's death from her sister, brother-in-law, nephews, and nieces. A few letters date from before the war, and a photograph of Aplin. The correspondence is archived in Ohio University's Mahn Center for Archives and Special Collections.

